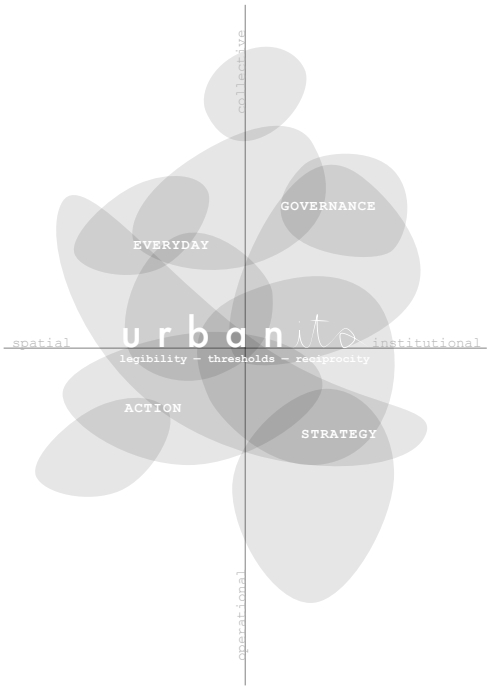
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Prototyping urban*ĭtas** in Practice.

01.2

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urban*ita* operates as an urban design practice through which the civic condition defined as *urbanĭtas* is tested within real contexts. Positioned between spatial configuration, institutional structures, and collective life, the practice engages the relation between design intentions, governance frameworks, and everyday urban experience.

The studio developed urban design as an activity that structures interaction across heterogeneous actors—public administrations, private stakeholders, and citizens—through situated processes of mediation, co-production, and strategic articulation. Spatial propositions, institutional logics, and social dynamics are brought into negotiation, enabling coordination and shared interpretation.

urban*ita* functions as a prototype of practice in which legibility, thresholds, and reciprocity are activated through intervention. This notebook establishes an operational link between the conceptual definition of urbanĭtas and its spatial and institutional translations, positioning practice as a mode of inquiry through which conditions are engaged, interpreted, and transformed.

POSITION — CONCEPT IN PRACTICE.

The Research Notebook Series establishes *urbanĭtas* as a civic condition shaped by the relation between spatial form, collective life, and institutional order. The **Human Environment** defines the field in which these relations take shape and evolve.

Notebook 01

Notebook 02

urban*ita* operated within this field as a practice studio and as an **in-between** operator. Developed between 2015 and 2023, the work engaged specific urban situations—ranging from shared spaces to neighbourhood initiatives—each characterised by distinct spatial, institutional, and collective configurations.

Notebook 00

Each project constituted a concrete instance in which conceptual positions were tested through practice. The work engaged the Human Environment as it presented itself, allowing relations between spatial, institutional, and social dimensions to take form through intervention.

Through this process, urban*ita* developed a cumulative understanding of how design engages and structures these relations in practice.

Problem — From Condition to Engagement

Urban conditions are shaped through the interaction of spatial, institutional, and collective dimensions. In practice, these dimensions operate across different temporalities and modes of action, with limited coordination between them.

Spatial interventions, governance processes, and everyday practices coexist within the same environments, and their interaction remains uneven. As a result, relations are difficult to structure, and conditions remain fragmented in their interpretation and transformation, limiting the capacity to act across domains.

Urban design engages this field by introducing situations in which these relations become explicit and operative. In practice, even small spatial or organisational shifts—such as the reconfiguration of a threshold or the activation of a shared space—can reveal patterns of use and open ground for coordination.

urban*ita* is positioned within this space of engagement, working where conditions take form through practice.

Practice — Situated Operations

urban*ita* operated through the construction of situations in which these relations could be structured directly.

Projects took form as interventions combining spatial action, collective use, and institutional interaction. They engaged specific contexts where spatial configurations were introduced or modified in response to existing conditions, and where actors interacted within shared environments.

Urban design acted directly on the relation between space, collective life, and governance. Spatial interventions contributed to legibility by making relations visible and interpretable. The organization of space established thresholds through which different domains interacted, while the involvement of actors supported forms of reciprocity that allowed conditions to evolve through use.

Practice unfolded over time through observation, adjustment, and repeated engagement, contributing to a cumulative understanding of how conditions operate and how they can be structured through design.

Mechanism — From Situation to Condition

The situations constructed through **urban***ita* structure relations in practice, activating the civic condition of *urbanĭtas*.

Legibility is established through spatial articulation, situating relations between places, actors, and processes within concrete environments. Thresholds are defined through the organization of interfaces between spatial, institutional, and collective domains, structuring points of interaction and negotiation. Reciprocity develops through the participation of actors within shared situations, allowing environments to remain responsive to collective life.

These operations engage the civic condition as an active field.

urban*ita* developed through a series of projects across different contexts, each working within specific configurations of the Human Environment.

These interventions addressed public space, collective use, and institutional conditions through spatial and relational operations. They unfolded across varying degrees of accessibility, fragmentation, and transformation, engaging a range of situations—from public spaces shaped by changing patterns of use to semi-public thresholds where governance and everyday practices intersect.

The projects function as fragments of practice, not complete solutions. They show how legibility is constructed through spatial intervention, how thresholds are defined within existing contexts, and how reciprocity emerges through collective engagement.

Each fragment provides situated evidence of how these relations are interpreted and transformed, contributing to the development of the practice.

Case Fragments — Practice in Context

OPENING — RELATIONAL PRACTICE.

urban*ita* establishes a practice through which urban design engages the relations that structure the Human Environment.

Spatial configuration, collective life, and institutional frameworks are addressed within concrete situations, where design operates through intervention, interaction, and adjustment over time. In this approach, conditions are understood as dynamic configurations shaped through use and governance.

This positioning extends urban design toward a mode of practice grounded in the activation of legibility, thresholds, and reciprocity within real contexts. It situates design within the ongoing structuring of spatial and institutional relations.

The question that follows concerns how such practices can extend beyond individual interventions—how they operate across time, scale, and contexts, and how their effects persist within evolving urban systems.

Recognition and Institutional Context

The work developed through **urban***ita* has been recognised within institutional, professional, and design contexts. Selected recognitions include:

. 100 Storie di Creatività — Lazio Creativo, 2017
Recognition in the Architecture and Design section.

. ADI Design Index — Design for Social Impact — ADI – Associazione per il Disegno Industriale, 2016
Recognition for the Sant'Anna Jamming project.

. Torno Subito Grant — Regione Lazio, 2016
Support for the development of **urban***ita*.

. Innovazione: Sostantivo Femminile — Regione Lazio, 2015 Funding for the Urban Crowd Raising (UCR) initiative.

urban*ita* has also been engaged within international institutional frameworks:

. UN-Habitat — World Urban Campaign Partner

. United Nations Global Compact Participant